ARU Validator — Quick start

This gets the validation app running on your computer and opens the rare-species databases you already have. It takes about 5 minutes the first time. You need R (which you already have) and an internet connection. You do **not** need git.

1. Install (once)

1. Open **R** (RGui or RStudio).
2. Copy this line (it is also on **github.com/tabanid/aru-validator**, where copying is easiest), paste it into the R console, and press **Enter**:

   ```
   source("https://raw.githubusercontent.com/tabanid/aru-validator/main/install_validator.R")
   ```

3. A window asks **where to put the app**. Pick any folder you like (for example *Documents*). A folder called **ARU-validator** is made inside it.
4. The first time, R installs a few packages. This can take a few minutes.
5. At the end, R prints two lines like these:

   ```
   Installed in: C:/Users/you/Documents/ARU-validator
   Version:      5.0+1a2b3c4
   ```

   Please send the "Installed in" line to Phil.
6. The app opens in your web browser. There is now an **ARU Validator** shortcut on your Desktop: use it next time.

2. Open your databases

1. Type your name or initials and click **OK**.
2. In **Open validation database**, type the folder that holds your species folders, for example `C:\Contracts\2026\tabanid\Tobeatic-rare`, and click **Open / Scan**.
3. Double-click a species in the list (or pick it and click **Open selected**). Next time the app starts in the same folder with the list already there.

3. Validate

Key	What it does
Space	play the selected clip
Y / **S** / **C**	yes: target species (S = song, C = call)
N · **I** · **P** · **U**	no · insect · peeper · unsure
other birds	click **Other species**, type codes (e.g. `BTNW NAWA`), **Enter**, then the clip's code
← → ↑ ↓	move between clips

Every label is saved the moment you press the key. There is nothing to save.

4. Stop

Click **Quit**, or close the browser tab and the black window.

5. Tell Phil

- the **Installed in** line;
- how long it took from pasting the line to validating your first clip;
- anything that was confusing or did not work (a screenshot helps);
- if you validated clips: which species.

To update later: paste the same line into R again. Your databases, clips and settings are never touched by an update.